

Online Insurance Sales

Standard Operating Procedure

Document Reference	SOP-INS-001
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Owner	Digital Sales & Distribution
Approved By	Chief Distribution Officer
Classification	Internal Use Only
Applicable To	All online auto and renter's insurance applications via the Meridian customer portal

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the end-to-end process for receiving, processing, and converting online insurance applications submitted through the Meridian Insurance Group digital portal. It ensures consistent underwriting controls, customer communication standards, and policy issuance timelines for auto and renter's insurance products sold without agent involvement.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to:

- All auto and renter's insurance applications submitted via the Meridian online portal or mobile app
- Quote generation, acceptance, and payment processing for direct digital sales
- Application processing by the Digital Operations team

This procedure does NOT cover: applications submitted through licensed agents or brokers (refer SOP-INS-008: Agent-Assisted Sales), commercial lines, or life insurance products.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Website Visitor / Applicant	Initiates quote request; submits application; provides accurate personal and vehicle/property information; makes initial premium payment.
Digital Operations Analyst	Monitors online application queue; reviews incomplete applications; triggers follow-up communications; escalates fraud flags.
Underwriting Staff	Performs risk review for applications flagged outside auto-accept rules; approves or declines borderline cases; sets manual rating adjustments.
Application Processing Staff	Validates application data against bureau sources; issues policy documents; updates policy administration system.
Customer Service / Call Centre	Handles inbound queries on application status; assists customers unable to complete the online process; handles payment failures.

4. Pre-requisites and Triggers

This process is triggered when a website visitor completes and submits the online application form.

Pre-requisites:

- Applicant is 18 years of age or older
- Valid email address and mobile number provided
- Product is available in applicant's state/territory
- Payment method (credit/debit card or direct debit) is presented at checkout

5. Process Steps

5.1 Quote Generation

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
1	Applicant enters vehicle/property details and personal information	Applicant	Portal auto-saves progress; session valid for 72 hours
2	Rating engine calculates premium	Portal / Rating Engine	Instant quote displayed; multi-product discount applied automatically if eligible
3	Quote presented to applicant with coverage options	Portal	Quote reference number generated; quote valid for 30 days
4	Applicant selects coverage tier and optional endorsements	Applicant	Selection recorded in portal; premium recalculated in real time

5.2 Application Submission and Validation

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
5	Applicant completes and submits full application	Applicant	Application ID assigned; data written to Policy Admin System (PAS)
6	Automated data validation and bureau checks	PAS / External Bureau	MVR, claims history, and credit score retrieved (where permitted); completed within 60 seconds
7	Auto-accept or refer decision	Underwriting Rules Engine	Auto-accept: proceed to Step 9. Refer: routed to underwriting queue.
8	Manual underwriting review (referred applications)	Underwriting Staff	Decision within 2 business hours; applicant notified by email

5.3 Payment and Policy Issuance

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
9	Applicant proceeds to payment	Applicant / Payment Gateway	Secure payment page; PCI-DSS compliant gateway
10	Payment authorised	Payment Gateway	Authorisation code recorded in PAS; failure triggers retry flow (max 3 attempts)
11	Policy issued in PAS	Application Processing Staff	Policy number generated; coverage effective immediately upon payment
12	Policy documents emailed to applicant	PAS / Email Engine	Certificate of Insurance, Policy Schedule, and PDS dispatched within 5 minutes
13	Welcome SMS sent	CRM	Includes policy number, emergency claims number, and portal login link

6. Decision Points and Exception Handling

6.1 Incomplete Application (Abandoned Cart)

If an applicant begins but does not complete the application:

- Portal sends automated reminder email at 24 hours and 72 hours after last activity
- If no completion after 7 days, application is archived; applicant may restart with saved quote reference
- Digital Operations Analyst reviews weekly abandonment report and may initiate outbound call for high-value quotes

6.2 Payment Failure

If the payment gateway returns a failure:

- Applicant is prompted to retry with same or alternate payment method (maximum 3 attempts in one session)
- After 3 failures, applicant is directed to Customer Service; application held for 24 hours
- Customer Service may process payment via alternate channel and complete issuance manually

6.3 Underwriting Decline

If the underwriting engine or manual review results in a decline:

- Applicant receives written decline notice by email within 2 business hours
- Adverse action notice includes statutory reason codes where required by regulation
- Application is flagged in PAS; applicant may reapply after 90 days unless a hard exclusion applies

7. Systems and Tools

System / Tool	Purpose	Access
Meridian Customer Portal	Online application capture, quote display, document delivery	Applicants, Digital Ops
Policy Administration System (PAS)	Policy creation, document generation, status tracking	Digital Ops, Underwriting, App Processing
Rating Engine	Real-time premium calculation based on risk attributes	Automated
Underwriting Rules Engine	Auto-accept / refer logic; bureau data integration	Automated / Underwriting
Payment Gateway (Stripe)	Secure payment processing, authorisation, refunds	Applicants, Customer Service
CRM (Salesforce)	Customer record, communication history, follow-up tasks	Digital Ops, Customer Service

8. Key Performance Indicators

- Quote-to-bind conversion rate: Minimum 18% of completed quotes result in a bound policy
- Application abandonment rate: Below 55% at the payment step
- Policy issuance time: 100% of auto-accept applications issued within 10 minutes of payment
- Underwriting referral SLA: 95% of referred applications decided within 2 business hours

- Payment failure rate: Below 4% of total application attempts

9. Related Documents

- SOP-INS-008: Agent-Assisted Sales
- SOP-INS-010: Policy Endorsement and Mid-Term Adjustment
- POL-UW-001: Personal Lines Underwriting Policy
- POL-IT-003: Payment Card Data Security (PCI-DSS)

10. Document Control and Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	10 Jan 2023	L. Nguyen, Digital Ops	Initial release
1.1	05 Aug 2024	L. Nguyen, Digital Ops	Added abandoned cart protocol; updated payment gateway to Stripe
1.2	01 Apr 2025	P. Santos, Digital Ops	Added SMS welcome step; aligned bureau check SLAs